

KINDERGARTEN

Enrolling a child in kindergarten is most parents' first exposure to their public school system. This policy provides parents with age and enrollment requirements for kindergarten students. This policy also provides guidance to parents who wish to explore first-grade placement of their kindergarten-aged children.

A. Age. To be eligible for admission to kindergarten, a child must be five years of age on or before September 30 of the school year.

B. Enrollment. Under the compulsory attendance laws of Virginia, a child whose fifth birthday falls on or before September 30 of a given year must be enrolled in school for that year. However, a child's attendance may be delayed for one year, if, in the opinion of the parent or guardian, the child is not mentally, physically, or emotionally prepared to attend school. If a child will be six years old on or before September 30, Virginia law requires the student to be enrolled in school.

C. Student Placement. A child may be placed in first grade if they were enrolled in and have successfully completed a kindergarten program in a public school system in another state or in a non-public school recognized as participating in the accreditation program under the auspices of the Virginia Council for Private Education. Parents of such children will be counseled about the advisability of such placement.

[Former Policy: 5-10]

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Leg Ref: Code of Virginia, 1950, as amended, §§ [22.1-199](#); [22.1-254](#); § Va. Code Ann. [8 VAC 20-131-60](#)